How Physicians Win in 2026:

The AI Answer Era

WebMD Care DIRECTORIES

How AI Reads and Recommends Your Practice





A WebMD Profile is the data feed the AI uses to find you.
40 million people a day are asking AI to choose a doctor for them. To be recommended, you need two things: Structured data so the AI can verify your expertise, and constant reviews so it knows you are active.

The Three Pillars of AI Visibility

1. AI Extraction: How AI "Sees" You

We act as a data translator, formatting credentials into "knowledge blocks" that AI crawlers are programmed to prioritize.

WebMD profiles give AI the signals it needs to vouch for you.

2. Schema Markup: The AI "ID Card"

We embed MedicalEntity Schema (hidden code) into every profile. It proves board certifications and experience to Gemini and ChatGPT.

WebMD profiles are more likely to be cited as a source in AI answers.

3. Review Velocity: The AI "Heartbeat"

LLMs use "sentiment analysis" to read review text. (e.g., A review mentioning "gentle" helps the AI match a doctor to a patient asking for a "painless experience").

Our tools help you maintain a constant stream of patient reviews.

The 2026 Reality



AI recommendations now influence **26% of patients**, nearly matching the power of PCP referrals (28%).



1 in 4 patients asks AI for a doctor by name. If the AI can't verify the doctor, it won't vouch for them.



people turn to **ChatGPT or Gemini** daily for healthcare questions.